SYNONYM AND ANTONYM CLUES

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Circle the clue word or phrase in each sentence, then write the meaning of the word in capitals.

PART 1: SYNONYM CLUES

The water was TEPID, or slightly warm, so the bath was not much fun.

_____

Grandma's garden is IMMACULATE; it is perfectly neat and clean.

_____

The dog was DOCILE and gentle, happy to be patted by every child.

_____

We had to HASTEN, that is, hurry, or we would miss the bus.

_____

The instructions were AMBIGUOUS, unclear in more than one way.

_____

The lake was TRANQUIL and calm in the early morning.

_____

Owls are NOCTURNAL: they are active at night and sleep in the day.

_____

PART 2: ANTONYM CLUES

Unlike his GREGARIOUS sister, who talks to everyone, Tom is shy.

_____

The first puzzle was simple, but the second was INTRICATE.

_____

Although the room looked SPACIOUS in the photo, it was cramped in real life.

_____

Instead of being GENEROUS with the sweets, he kept them all for himself.

_____

The path was SLICK with ice, not dry and safe as we had hoped.

_____

Our old cat is LETHARGIC now, while the kitten never stops racing about.

_____

The critic's review was SCATHING rather than kind.

_____

1. Four signal words that often point to an antonym clue: _____, _____, _____ and _____.

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SYNONYM AND ANTONYM CLUES ANSWER KEY

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

PART 1: SYNONYM CLUES

1. slightly warm (clue: or slightly warm) 2. perfectly neat and clean 3. gentle, easy to handle 4. hurry 5. unclear, with more than one meaning 6. calm, peaceful 7. active at night

PART 2: ANTONYM CLUES

1. sociable, outgoing (opposite: shy) 2. complicated, detailed (opposite: simple) 3. roomy, with plenty of space (opposite: cramped) 4. giving, willing to share (opposite: kept them all) 5. slippery (opposite: dry and safe) 6. slow and sleepy, lacking energy (opposite: never stops racing) 7. harsh, very critical (opposite: kind)

1. unlike, but, although, instead of (also: while, rather than, not)

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